004-10 RERRENCHMENT 裁员

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Partly because it benefited from *the Imperial Preferences 偏爱，偏好；优待，优先（权）system* instituted after *the Imperial Economic Conference of 1932* in Ottawa, Hong Kong was not seriously hurt (v.) by the Great Depression.

Example 1. 案例
the Imperial Preferences system 帝国特惠制

Imperial Preferences system 是 1932 年在渥太华会议上建立的一种贸易保护制度。

- 核心逻辑： **英国及其殖民地、自治领（如加拿大、澳大利亚等）之间互相降低关税。**
- 对外墙： **对非大英帝国的国家（如日本、美国、德国）出口的产品，征收高额关税。**

为什么它救了当时的香港？

当时正值 Great Depression（大萧条），全球贸易萎缩，各国都筑起关税高墙。香港作为一个转口港，生意大受打击。

但在该制度下，香港获得了“入场券”：

- 低成本出口： **香港制造的产品（如手电筒、胶鞋、针织品）只要证明一定比例的原材料或加工是在香港（帝国领土）完成的，就可以以极低甚至零关税，进入英国及其广大的殖民地市场。**
- 竞争优势： **当时日本货虽然便宜，但在东南亚和非洲的英国殖民地，会被征收重税；而香港货因为有“帝国特惠制”护身，反而比日本货更有竞争力。**

Still, officials in Britain and in Hong Kong grew (v.) concerned about the colony's expenditures 开支；花费；支出 and began to demand (v.) retrenchment (n.)削减；紧缩 in the civil service 公务员体系；行政部门 by appointing more non-Europeans.

Example 2. 案例
retrenchment

→ re-,向后，往回，-trench,砍，劈，词源同 truncate,trunk.引申词义节约，缩减。 retrial 复审，再审

Although governors frequently **drew (v.) attention to** 引起对…的注意,使……关注；提醒…注意 the large number of Europeans in the public sector **compared to** other British colonies, until 1930 there was no local demand (n.) to replace (v.) Europeans with local Chinese civil servants.

尽管总督们经常强调，与其他英国殖民地相比，该地区公共部门中的欧洲人数量众多，但直到1930年，当地都没有出现用本地华人公务员取代欧洲人的诉求。

On the contrary 相反, in 1914 the European unofficial members of the Legislative Council requested (v.)要求，请求 that /the government hire (v.) more European nurses at the government civil hospital, even though the hospital already had more Europeans than in similar hospitals in the British Empire.

In 1921, there were more than 180 Europeans in the police force, compared with 与……相比 40 in Singapore and 23 in Ceylon 锡兰(斯里兰卡) (whose population was more than six times that of Hong Kong).

Not only was this an issue of racial discrimination 种族歧视, it was also very costly (a.)昂贵的,价大的.

In 1914 a European police constable 治安官，巡警,警察 **received more than seven times the pay** of a local Chinese or Indian constable, while in 1939, the lowest-ranking 最低级别的；最低职位的 European policeman received almost **eight times the pay** of a Chinese of the same rank 级别；等级；职位.

Example 3. 案例

Partly because it benefited from the Imperial Preferences system instituted after the Imperial Economic Conference of 1932 in Ottawa, Hong Kong was not seriously hurt by the Great Depression.
Still, officials in Britain and in Hong Kong grew concerned about the colony's expenditures and began to demand retrenchment in the civil service by appointing more non-Europeans.
Although governors frequently drew attention to the large number of Europeans in the public sector compared to other British colonies, until 1930 there was no local demand to replace Europeans with local Chinese civil servants.
On the contrary, in 1914 the European unofficial members of the Legislative Council requested that the government hire more European nurses at the government civil hospital, even though the hospital already had more Europeans than in similar hospitals in the British Empire.
In 1921, there were more than 180 Europeans in the police force, compared with 40 in Singapore and 23 in Ceylon (whose population was more than six times that of Hong Kong).
Not only was this an issue of racial discrimination, it was also very costly.
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部分原因是得益于1932年渥太华帝国经济会议后设立的帝国特惠制, 香港并未受到大萧条的严重冲击。尽管如此, 英国和香港的官员仍对殖民地的开支感到担忧, 并开始要求通过任命更多非欧洲裔人士来精简公务员队伍。虽然总督经常强调香港公共部门的欧洲裔人士数量远超其他英国殖民地, 但直到1930年, 香港本地并没有要求用华裔公务员取代欧洲裔人士。相反, 1914年, 立法会的欧洲裔非官方议员要求政府在公立医院增聘欧洲裔护士, 尽管当时该医院的欧洲裔护士人数已经超过了英属殖民地其他同类医院。1921年, 香港警队中有超过180名欧洲裔人士, 而新加坡只有40名, 锡兰（人口是香港的六倍多）也只有23名。这不仅是种族歧视问题, 而且代价高昂。1914年, 一名欧洲裔警察的薪水是当地华裔或印度裔警察的七倍多；而到了1939年, 级别最低的欧洲裔警察的薪水几乎是同级别华裔警察的八倍。

Colonial officials and European residents often justified (v.)证明…正确；为…辩护 the large numbers of Europeans in government service 政府服务 by arguing that /they were less corrupt (a.v.)腐败的；贪污的 and more trustworthy (a.)值得信赖的；可靠的 and efficient than Chinese *as well as* more loyal (a.) to Britain.

Fearing that Cantonese 广东的；粤语的 policemen would be **neither** 两者都不 able **nor** willing to control (v.) their fellow Cantonese, the government recruited 招募；征召

policemen from Britain, India, or Weihaiwei.

Only on the eve of World War II were Chinese police admitted 接纳；准许进入 at the rank 级别；等级 of subinspector 副督察；下级督察, and even then they were under the control of more junior 职位较低的；资历较浅的 British officers.

Example 4. 案例
subinspector

副督察：在某些国家，尤其是英联邦国家，副督察是警察部门的一种职位，通常位于督察和警官之间。

▶ Gemini:

Sub-inspector 是什么级别？
在当时的职级序列中，它是**督察级（Inspectorate）**的入门级：

地位： 属于“委任级”官员（持有委任状），开始进入管理层。

文中含义： 到二战前夕才允许华人担任此职，说明此前华人只能做底层的警员（Constable）或警长（Sergeant），无法进入指挥层。

香港警察的职级通常分为三大职别(从高到低):

类别	主要职级（中文/英文）	职责与地位
宪委级 (Gazetted Officers)	警务处长 (CP) / 助理处长 (ACP) / 总警司 (CSP)	最高决策层，负责全港或整个大区的战略和管理。
督察级 (Inspectorate)	总督察 (CIP) / 高级督察 (SIP) / 督察 (IP) / 副督察 (Sub-IP)	中层指挥官。负责一个小分队（Platoon）或一个部门的日常行动。
员佐级 (Junior Police Officers)	警署警长 (SSGT) / 警长 (SGT) / 高级警员 (SPC) / 警员 (PC)	一线执行人员。负责巡逻、抓捕、处理突发事件。

各级职责:

Header 1	Header 2
员佐级 (JPO) — “兵”：	• 职能： 维持治安的第一线。**你平时在街上看到巡逻（军装），或处理交通事故的警员，主要属于这一级。** • 标志： 肩章上是数字或简单的条纹（俗称“三划”或“两划”）。
督察级 (Inspectorate) — “将”：	• 职能： **现场指挥官。**比如一个案件现场，**"督察"负责部署"员佐级警员"的工作。**他们需要撰写调查报告，并在法庭上作证。 • 标志： 肩章上是“花”（军星），俗称“一粒花”、“两粒花”。
宪委级 (Gazetted) — “帅”：	• 职能： **政策制定。他们不直接参与街头追捕，而是负责资源分配、跨部门协作和警队形象。** • 标志： 肩章上有皇冠（现为紫荆花）和桂叶装饰。

现在香港警察已经取消了 Sub-inspector (副督察) 这个职衔，统一改为 Inspector (督察)。新入职的大学毕业生通过考核后，会直接被授予“见习督察”（Probationary Inspector）职衔。

Many clerical 文书的；办事员的 positions held by Europeans were subsequently filled by their sons.

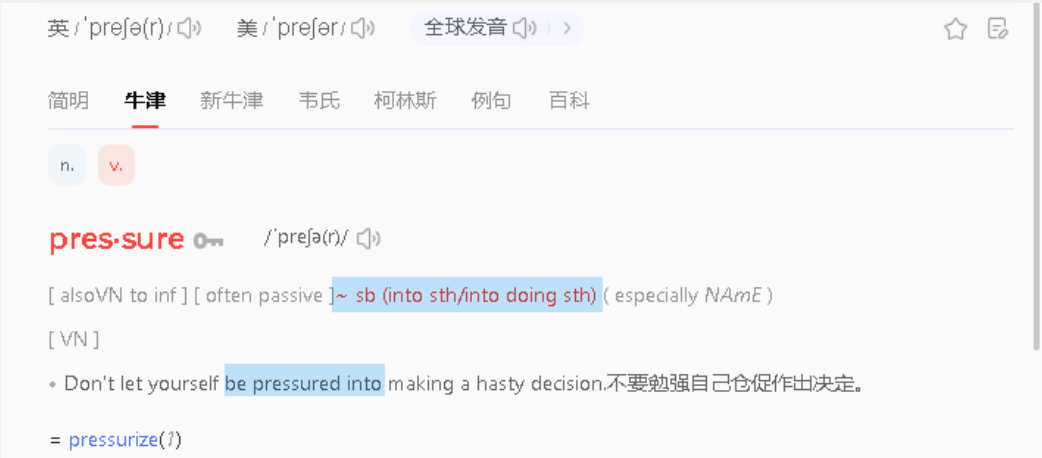
(Some of these Europeans were in fact **more** connected (a.) to Hong Kong **than** most Chinese residents were.
According to the 1931 census 人口普查, Europeans in Hong Kong were slightly 稍微；略微 **less** migratory (a.)迁移的；流动的 **than** urban 城市的；城镇的 Chinese, for 8.5 percent of them had been in Hong Kong for more than thirty years, **compared to** 6.4 percent for the urban Chinese.)

（事实上，这些欧洲人中的一部分，与香港的联系比大多数中国居民还要紧密。根据1931年的人口普查，香港的欧洲人比城市华人的流动性略低，因为8.5%的欧洲人在香港居住了30年以上，而城市华人的这一比例为6.4%。）

Neither the European **nor** the Chinese unofficial members of the Legislative Council 谓 urged (v.) the government to hire (v.) more local residents.

Although the Colonial Office preferred (v.) more local appointments 任命；委派 as a way **to lower (v.) salaries**, it rarely 很少；难得 tried (v.) **to pressure** (v.) the Hong Kong government **into** doing so.

Example 5. 案例
pressure



Example 6. 案例

Colonial officials and European residents often justified the large numbers of Europeans in government service by arguing that they were less corrupt and more trustworthy and efficient than Chinese as well as more loyal to Britain.
Fearing that Cantonese policemen would be neither able nor willing to control their fellow Cantonese, the government recruited policemen from Britain, India, or Weihaiwei.
Only on the eve of World War II were Chinese police admitted at the rank of subinspector, and even then they were under the control of more junior British officers.
Many clerical positions held by Europeans were subsequently filled by their sons.
(Some of these Europeans were in fact more connected to Hong Kong than most Chinese residents were.
According to the 1931 census, Europeans in Hong Kong were slightly less migratory than urban Chinese, for 8.5 percent of them had been in Hong Kong for more than thirty years, compared to 6.4 percent for the urban Chinese.) Neither the European nor the Chinese unofficial members of the Legislative Council urged the government to hire more local residents.
Although the Colonial Office preferred more local appointments as a way to lower salaries, it rarely tried to pressure the Hong Kong government into doing so.

殖民官员和欧洲居民常常辩称，政府部门大量聘用欧洲人，是因为欧洲人比中国人更廉洁、更值得信赖、效率更高，也更忠于英国。由于担心广东警察既无力也无意管束同胞，政府从英国、印度或威海卫招募警察。直到二战前夕，中国警察才被允许担任副督察一职，即便如此，他们也受制于级别更低的英国警官。许多欧洲人担任的文职职位后来都由他们的儿子接任。（事实上，一些欧洲人与香港的联系比大多数中国居民更为紧密。根据1931年的人口普查，香港的欧洲人比城市中国人的迁徙程度略低，其中8.5%的欧洲人在香港居住超过30

年, 而城市中国人的这一比例为6.4%。）立法会的欧洲和中国非官方议员都没有敦促政府雇用更多本地居民。虽然殖民地事务部更倾向于更多地聘用本地人以降低工资, 但它很少试图向香港政府施压, 迫使其这样做。

After 1930, when a report on government salaries **led to** a public uproar (n.)骚动；骚乱, governors and the Chinese, Eurasian, and Portuguese members of the Legislative Council 谓 increasingly **called for** more local hires.

Lo Man Kam, the Eurasian lawyer and one of the "Chinese" unofficial members of the Legislative Council, vigorously 强烈地；有力地 supported (v.) this policy, which was accepted by Governor Andrew Caldecott in 1935.

In 1936 the government **agreed**, in principle 原则上；大体上, **that** /before vacancies 空缺；职位空缺 were advertised (v.)登广告 in Britain, qualified (a.)有资格的；合格的 local candidates 候选人 would be considered.

1936年，政府原则上同意，在英国发布职位空缺广告之前，会先考虑合格的本地候选人。

Progress was slow, however, not just because of the entrenched 根深蒂固的；牢固的 *vested (a.)既定的 interests* 既得利益 of the European community but also because the low salaries 后定说明 **compared to** those for Europeans 谓 **discouraged** 使气馁；阻碍 *qualified Chinese candidates* **from** applying.

Example 7. 案例
vested

ADJ. having a present right to the immediate or future possession and enjoyment of property 既定的 (拥有当前权利，可立即或在未来占有和享用财产)

Although *differences in pay* 薪酬差异 actually increased (v.) during the 1930s /because of the depreciation 贬值；跌价 of the Hong Kong dollar, 主 the Chinese and Eurasian unofficial members of the Legislative Council 谓 never insisted that /Chinese should draw (v.)领取（薪水） the same salaries as Europeans.

尽管由于港元贬值，20世纪30年代的薪酬差距实际上有所扩大，但立法局的华人, 及欧亚裔非官守议员, 从未坚持要求华人应与欧洲人领取同等薪资。

Chinese did not serve (v.) in large numbers until after World War II, and *even though* in 1946 Britain's Labour government 工党政府 ordered that /主 civil service 公务员；行政部门 positions throughout the empire 谓 should **be opened to** local recruits 新成员；新雇员, up to 1966 /only a handful of Chinese had **been appointed to** senior 高级的；资深的 government positions.

"Until localization 本地化；本土化 was *the order of the day* 当日议程,流行的事物；风尚, in the 1980s," concludes David Faure, "`主` no Hong Kong Chinese, *however* well educated *and however* well established 地位稳固的；事业成功的 in his or her own profession, 谓 could reasonably 合理地；明智地 have seen that /he or she could **have gone very far** in government service."

大卫·福尔总结道："在 20 世纪 80 年代本地化成为主流之前，任何香港华人，无论受过多么良好的教育，在自己的专业领域多么有建树，都很难指望自己能在政府部门有多大的发展。"

Example 8. 案例

我问: 这句话里, 既然 could reasonably have seen that 这里的"看到"这个动作, 是发生再1980之前, 而1980已经是"过去时"了, 那么"过去的过去", 不是应该用 had seen that 么? 为什么这里还是用了 have seen that ?

▶ DeepSeek:

这里使用 "could have seen",因为它属于虚拟语气（Subjunctive Mood）中的"对过去的虚拟"（Past Unreal Conditional），而不是单纯的"过去完成时"。

虚拟语气用来表达与事实相反的情况、假设或愿望。在这句话中，作者想表达的是：
"在1980年代之前，没有一个香港华人（无论多优秀）能够（在当时）预见到,自己能在政府中走得很远。"

这里的"预见到"并不是一个真实发生过的动作，而是一种基于当时条件的推测或可能性。由于这种可能性在当时并未实现（他们实际上没看到），**所以必须用虚拟语气。**

"could have seen" 在这里表达的是对过去能力的否定推测。意思是：在当时（1980年代之前）的条件下，他们不可能（在当时）预见到未来的发展。**如果换成 had seen，意思就变成了"他们已经看到了"，这与作者想表达的"没看到"或"不可能看到"完全相反。**

-had seen：描述事实（已经看到了）。
- could have seen：描述假设（本可以看到，但没看到. 因为当时没有本地化政策）。

Example 9. 案例

After 1930, when a report on government salaries led to a public uproar, governors and the Chinese, Eurasian, and Portuguese members of the Legislative Council increasingly called for more local hires.
Lo Man Kam, the Eurasian lawyer and one of the "Chinese" unofficial members of the Legislative Council, vigorously supported this policy, which was accepted by Governor Andrew Caldecott in 1935.
In 1936 the government agreed, in principle, that before vacancies were advertised in Britain, qualified local candidates would be considered.
Progress was slow, however, not just because of the entrenched vested interests of the European community but also because the low salaries compared to those for Europeans discouraged qualified Chinese candidates from applying.
Although differences in pay actually increased during the 1930s because of the depreciation of the Hong Kong dollar, the Chinese and Eurasian unofficial members of the Legislative Council never insisted that Chinese should draw the same salaries as Europeans.
Chinese did not serve in large numbers until after World War II, and even though in 1946 Britain's Labour government ordered that civil service positions throughout the empire should be opened to local recruits, up to 1966 only a handful of Chinese had been appointed to senior government positions.
"Until localization was the order of the day, in the 1980s," concludes David Faure, "no Hong Kong Chinese, however well educated and however well established in his or her own profession, could reasonably have seen that he or she could have gone very far in government service."29 1930 年, 一份关于政府薪俸的报告引发公众强烈抗议后, 港督和立法会的华裔、欧亚裔及葡裔议员日益呼吁更多地雇用本地人。欧亚裔律师罗文锦是立法会"华裔"非正式议员之一, 他大力支持这项政策, 并于 1935 年被港督嘉德阁采纳。1936 年, 政府原则上同意, 在英国刊登职位空缺广告之前, 会优先考虑符合条件的本地候选人。然而, 进展缓慢, 这不仅是因为欧洲共同体根深蒂固的既得利益, 也是因为与欧洲人相比, 香港的薪俸较低, 令符合条件的华裔候选人望而却步。尽管由于港元贬值, 20 世纪 30 年代华裔和欧裔之间的薪俸差距实际上有所扩大, 但立法会的华裔和欧裔非正式议员从未坚持要求华裔应与欧洲人领取同等薪俸。二战后, 华人才开始大量服役。尽管 1946 年英国工党政府下令, 整个帝国的公务员职位都应向本地人开放, 但直到 1966 年, 也只有极少数华人被任命为政府高级职位。戴维·福尔总结道："直到 20 世纪 80 年代本地化成为主流政策之前, 任何香港华人, 无论受过多么良好的教育, 无论在各自的专业领域多么成功, 都很难想象自己能在政府部门获得很高的晋升机会。" 29